

Scoreboard

HDD Based PMPs

BRAND MODEL	Apple iPod Classic 80 GB	Apple iPod Classic 160 GB	Cowon A3 30 GB	Cowon A3 60 GB	Creative Zen Vision W
					
Price (Rupees)	Rs 14,600	Rs 20,500	Rs 23,000	Rs 26,000	Rs 29,999
Comments	+ Great performance and storage - Lacks FM Radio, slightly heavy	+ Great performance, huge storage - Lacks FM Radio, slightly heavy	+ Amazing screen, great features - Bulky, lower volumes	+ Amazing screen, great features - Bulky, lower volumes	+ Large, crisp screen, good music quality - Costly, bulky, non intuitive controls
Grand Totals (Out of 100)	68.57	68.57	65.53	65.53	70.54
Features (Out of 35)	22.93	22.93	22.61	22.61	22.30
Performance (Out of 65)	45.65	45.65	42.92	42.92	48.25
Features					
Capacity	80 GB	160 GB	30 GB	60 GB	30 GB
Display Type	LCD	LCD	LCD	LCD	LCD
Display Number of Colours	262K	262K	16.7M	16.7M	262K
Display Size	2.5 inches	2.5 inches	4 inches	4 inches	4.3 inches
Type of Battery	Li-ion	Li-ion	Li-ion	Li-ion	Li-ion
Weight of Device	149 gm	162 gm	280 gm	280 gm	276 gm
Firmware Upgradeable (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Memory Upgradeable (Y/N) / Type of Memory	N / NA	N / NA	N / NA	N / NA	N / NA
FM Tuner (Y/N)	N	N	Y	Y	Y
Voice Recording (Y/N)	N	N	Y	Y	Y
Audio Formats supported	MP3, AAC, AIFF, WAV	MP3, AAC, AIFF, WAV	MP3, WMA, ASF, FLAC, OGG, M4A, MATROSKA(MKA), APE, WAV	MP3, WMA, ASF, FLAC, OGG, M4A, MATROSKA(MKA), APE, WAV	MP3, WMA, WAV
Photo Viewing / Video Playback (Y/N)	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y
Video Formats supported	H.264, MOV, MP4, MPEG-4	H.264, MOV, MP4, MPEG-4	AVI, WMV, ASF, MP4, MATROSKA (MKV), OGM, MPG/MPEG, VOB, DAT	AVI, WMV, ASF, MP4, MATROSKA (MKV), OGM, MPG/MPEG, VOB, DAT	AVI, WMV9, MPEG-1/2, MPEG-4-SP, MJPEG, DivX 4.x/ 5.x, XviD-SP
Screen Brightness adjust (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Screen Orientation Sensor (Y/N)	N	N	N	N	N
Built-in Speakers (Y/N)	N	N	Y	Y	Y
No of Preset Modes / Customisable Equaliser	22 / N	22 / N	6 / Y	6 / Y	8 / Y
Point A to B Track Repeat (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Custom Playlist saving (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Folder Creation (Y/N)	N	N	Y	Y	Y
Use as Portable Drive (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Addon Features					
Built-in Calendar / Contacts / Stopwatch / Alarm	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	N / N / N / N	N / N / N / N	N / N / N / N
Bundled Accessories	N	N	Carry case, handstrap, AV Out cables, a/c charger	Carry case, handstrap, AV Out cables, a/c charger	Carry Case, AV Out cables
Additional Features (If any)	N	N	N	N	N
Performance					
General Display Performance (So 10)	6.5	6.5	9	9	8.5
Video Performance (Movies) (So 10)	7	7	9	9	8.5
Music Performance (Out of 10)					
Eagles—Hotel California	8.25	8.25	7	7	8.5
The Corrs—Brid og ni Mhaille	8.25	8.25	7	7	8.25
Charlotte Church—Bridge over Troubled Water	8.25	8.25	6.75	6.75	8.25
Pink Floyd—Speak to Me / Breathe	8	8	6.5	6.5	8.25
Dire Straits—Sultans of Swing	8.25	8.25	6.75	6.75	8
Guns N' Roses—November Rain (Live)	8	8	7	7	8
Eric Clapton—Layla	8	8	6.75	6.75	8.25
Chand Sifarish (Fanaa)	8.25	8.25	7.25	7.25	8.25
Beedi (Omkaara)	7.75	7.75	6.75	6.75	8
Bundled Headphone Quality (Out of 10)	5.5	5.5	6.25	6.25	6.25
Battery Life (Actual Tested)	17.5 h	17.5 h	12.8 h	12.6 h	11.7 h

Decision Maker

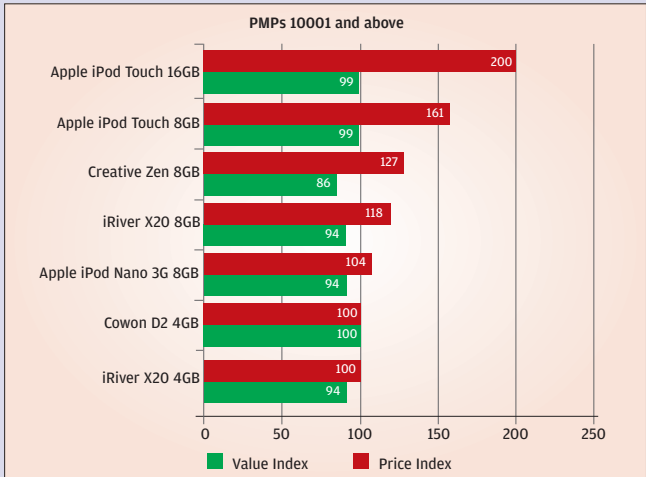
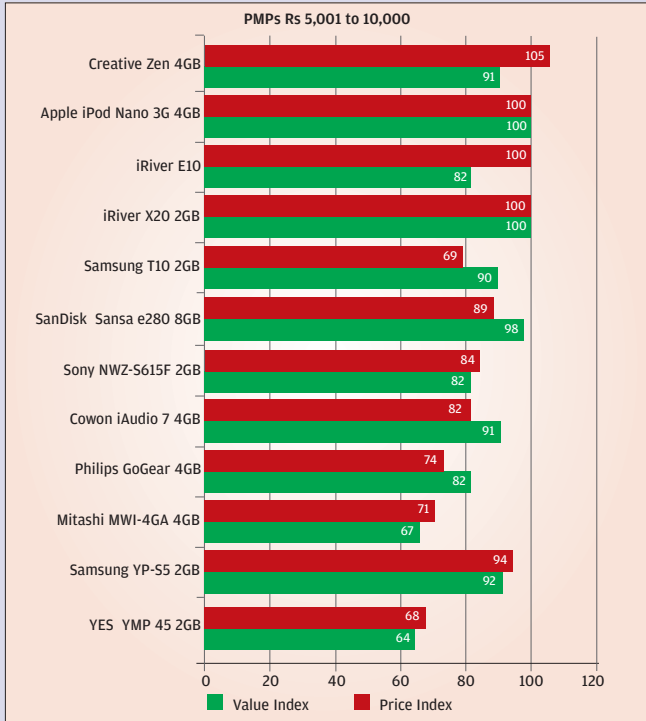
Great sound, something really compact, and feature-rich: Don't look anywhere beyond the new iPod Nano 3G. In its 4 GB avatar, the Nano is priced at Rs 8,500 and the 8 GB version costs Rs 11,500—perfect performance and features for its price. It's a true audiophile's delight, and will satisfy your cravings for pure sound like nothing else in its price bracket. **A video oriented PMP for watching high quality videos:** The Cowon A3 has got to be your target. Priced very conservatively at Rs 20,000 for the 30 GB version, the Cowon has the best processing hardware under its hood and can even be hooked up to your television—it's a fully functional DVD player! Music quality is very good, but not up to the iPod Nano, iPod Touch, or Cowon D2.

Something really cheap—sound quality isn't that important: How does Rs 1,500 sound to you? Supercomp's SEMP3-S7A will certainly do the trick. It's got a small screen, besides very good music quality for the price. You'll be surprised at how much PMP you get for your money.

A feature rich PMP, and one that is well priced. Music quality is important: Performance with Value? Look no further than the Cowon D2. At Rs 11,000, it represents sterling value, with a 16.7 million colour touchscreen that's shockingly adept at video, and stunning audio performance.

I have a budget of Rs 7,000. I want the best device for the price: Samsung's YP-S5 is the answer. An excellent screen, amazing audio quality, video playback, funky backlit touch controls, FM radio support, Bluetooth, photo viewing and a customisable equaliser. And it only costs Rs 6,600, too.

I'm rich, money isn't a concern...show me the best: Other than the private jet and the yacht you no doubt own, look at the Apple iPod Touch 16 GB. Or better still, wait a bit for the 32 GB version. The amazing touchscreen will be a feature you'll find eminently practical after a while, adding to your sex appeal, while the music quality will blow those 1,000 rupee socks off!



I want a great PMP for music but have a huge collection of MP3s that I wish to cart around: Apple's 80 GB and 160 GB iPod Classic will satisfy. Which one you buy is purely dependent on your storage needs, but they're both equally amazing music players, with strong video playback performance as well. Battery life is also very good for an HDD-based PMP. The icing on the cake is the shocking price—the lowest cost per GB from such exemplary PMPs makes your decision a no-brainer.

